

PATIENT
Raul Falcon

DOB 10/18/2002
 AGE 23 yrs
 SEX Male
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ENCOUNTER
Office Visit

NOTE TYPE SOAP Note
 SEEN BY Achina Stein
 DATE 04/29/2026
 AGE AT DOS 23 yrs
 Not signed

Plan

Hi Raul,

It was good to see you. Good luck on your job search in Boston! Your MSQ remains at zero which is wonderful. While you strive for balance and stability with regard to the ketogenic diet, keep in mind you are incredibly healthy and in a better state than before. Give yourself grace.

You are doing an amazing job!

This is your optimal health plan and D.R.E.S.S.® Protocol. DRESS stands for diet, rest, exercise, stress, and supplements. Any hyperlinks will need to be copied and pasted.

ACTION ITEMS:

- Consider working with Nancy on the psychology of eating around junk food or overeating fat bombs. You are doing great, but have feelings around this and junk food will affect your ability to maintain ketosis. She can help!
- Continue to track and trial foods to stabilize ketones to your "sweet spot" of 1.5-2
- Consider an advanced lipid panel or a CAC test (Coronary Artery Calcium) to retrieve a score to further assess cardiac health if you are concerned.
 - Elevated LDLs alone do not depict a danger.
 - The rest of your lipid panel and other biomarkers are quite healthy.
 - LDLs may just be mobilized from the visceral tissue right now while on a ketogenic diet. This is normal.
 - You have also improved metabolic health overall and lowered risks of psych meds as well as an MSQ score of 0.
- Since you are on Lithium, serum creatinine levels need to be monitored closely as lithium can affect kidney function over time - watch the trend of the Creatinine despite it being within normal range
- Labs in the future/before our next appointment. We will order these once we know when you can come back into the office.
 - I or another provider can order these for an October appt: Free and total carnitine, CMP, TSH, free T3, free T4, CBC with diff, lipid panel. Providing a lab slip for you will depend on where you are physically located in September
 - I can also add an advanced cardiac panel - NMR fractionated lipoprotein panel, ApoB:Apo A1, MPO, Lp(a).
 - You will need to fast 12 hours.
 - We can also order a **coronary artery calcium (CAC) scan** is a non-invasive CT scan that measures calcified plaque in the heart's arteries to assess heart attack risk. It provides a score (0 to >1,000) helping clinicians determine if patients with intermediate risk need statin therapy or lifestyle changes. The quick, 10-15 minute test is ideal for asymptomatic patients aged 40-75 but is being recommended more often on those patients on the ketogenic diet.

LAB RESULTS - Overview

- Lipid panel:
 - HDLs are 52 and we want them to be greater than 65 for optimal numbers. You can increase them by switching to fish instead of pork belly; add more omega-3s foods - flax seed, chia seed
 - We can assess elevated LDL if you are interested and concerned
- Vitamin D is optimal. Lower dose to 1 capsule daily
- Lithium level is 1.13 and reflects 1350mg of lithium and Creatinine - 0.92

DIET:

You have discovered your “sweet spot” for ketones is 1.5-2.0 Lower (0.6-1) does not give you optimal results, but higher (2.0 -2.9) puts you at risk for sleep disturbance and psychotic symptoms.

You have also learned that eating junk food has impacted your mood, function, and ability to maintain ketosis. Reminding yourself of the consequences of your choice and how long they last 4-7 days) will help you to make better choices and crave less. When we impede our progress, we just need to use that as an opportunity to learn. The disruption is typically 4 or more days to get back on track. Ask yourself if it is worth it.

Recommendations:

- Add small quantities of foods with more carbohydrates as indicated below until you find how much of which foods help you stabilize ketones without dropping them too low
- Consider tracking more closely so you can find the foods that are keeping you in the 1.5-2 ketone range. The CRONOMETER APP is a good tracking app to utilize and assess your intake
- Consider watching videos from Nicole Laurent on YouTube for Ketosis. She is also featured on the Metabolic Mind Website/YouTube channel and www.dietdoctor.com which also has a You Tube: www.youtube.com/@dietdoctor
- Instead of junk food, stick to the fat bombs for now as you reflect on and work on how to mitigate the “psychology” of overeating.
- Consider reducing pork belly and increasing good fats like higher omega 3 foods (fish e.g., salmon, sardines, and anchovy; nuts like walnuts, flaxseed and chia seed)

Examples of carbohydrate foods (adjust quantities based on outcomes)

10 grams:

- ½ cup blueberries, 1 small kiwi, 1 cup raspberries, ¾ cup strawberries
- 15 g macadamia nuts (small handful)

15 grams:

- 1/3 cup cooked sweet potato
- 1 medium apple (small), 1 cup blueberries, 1 medium peach, 1 cup pineapple chunks
- 20 g cashews
- ½ cup cooked carrots + ½ cup zucchini

20 grams

- 1/2 cup sweet potato (or similar tuber)
- 1 medium apple, 1 cup mango, 1 large peach
- ½ cup cooked beets
- 30 g cashews
- 1 cup blueberries + 1 tbsp almond butter

25 grams

- ¾ cups cooked sweet potato or similar
- 1 cup cooked squash or pumpkin (butternut or acorn)
- ¾ cup white rice with added oil or fat (if tolerated, can be very effective for cortisol even though high GI)
- 1 apple + small handful macadamias
- 1 medium banana (borderline keto, useful for sleep)

Hydration

- Continue to hydrate as you have been
- We do not usually recommend electrolytes while you are on Lithium, but adding a very small amount of SOS (low sodium electrolyte) may help with metabolic flexibility and can be helpful on a ketogenic diet
 - Please take at the same time and the same amount every day and monitor lithium levels

REST:

- Your sleep has returned to normal

- You have discovered high ketones affect sleep quality
- Continue to use the WHOOP device to track sleep
- Please access first light in the AM upon waking (go outside)

EXERCISE:

- Continue with your exercise regimen (strength training 2X weekly, running/cardio 2X weekly)
- Track calorie/food intake to be sure you are eating enough to stabilize ketones on heavier exercise days.
- You will use glucose, then glycogen (stored glucose) will deplete before accessing fat.
- You can bring ketosis on more quickly if you move after eating food if you find your ketones are too low.
- Under-eating causes stress and therefore an increase in cortisol. This in turn will keep ketones too low.

STRESS REDUCTION:

- Please continue to work on meditation by expanding the amount of time you use prior to bed (increase from 5 minutes to 10-20 minutes).
- Please focus on breathwork - even if you habit stack before meals, while in shower, post workout, before bed, anytime you are waiting, etc.
- The work you feel you need to maintain this ketogenic diet is the challenge of refraining from junk foods that pull you out of ketosis and disrupt you for days; or, overeating keto-friendly snacks like fat bombs
- We recommend you work with Nancy who is trained in the psychology of eating but can also give you tools to lower stress and return to parasympathetic mode
 - Talk to her about doing a nervous system reset

SUPPLEMENTS:

Always sequence and titrate new supplements:

- Sequence - start each supplement one at a time for at least 2 days
- Titrate - some supplements will need to be increased gradually.

CHANGE DOSING:

- Nordic Naturals ProOmega 2000 - increase to 3 gel caps daily with food to increase HDL. Be aware that if you have surgery planned, stop this 1 week before.
- Seeking Health Vitamin D3 K2 5000 - reduce to 1 capsule daily with food in the AM

CONTINUE:

- Metagenics PhytoMulti - take 2 tablets daily with food
- Cortisol Manager - 1 capsule at bedtime as you work on regulating your nervous system. You should not need this long and because you need it is a reason why stress reduction habits are important to implement
- Vital Nutrients B6 + B Complex - take 1 capsule daily with food

FOLLOW UP appointment:

July 1, 2026 at 10:00am ET via ZOOM WITH APRIL RITCHOTTE FDN-P

Schedule with Dr. Stein in September - October in the OFFICE. Draw bloodwork 2 weeks prior.

A link will be sent to you via email with the pre-appt form ahead of time.

You will receive a pre-appt form to complete 10 days before the appt. Please complete 48 hours or earlier than the appt to give time to get it uploaded into the computer. We don't want to take time during the appt to do this for my review

Let me know if you have any questions.

Achina Stein DO

April Ritchotte FDNP

Total time spent face to face: 60 min. Total time spent counseling/education was greater than 50%Content of counseling: Educated about nutrition, reason for dietary changes, gut permeability and its causes, stress management, importance of exercise, sleep hygiene.

